

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/9: Category firewall: language is not race

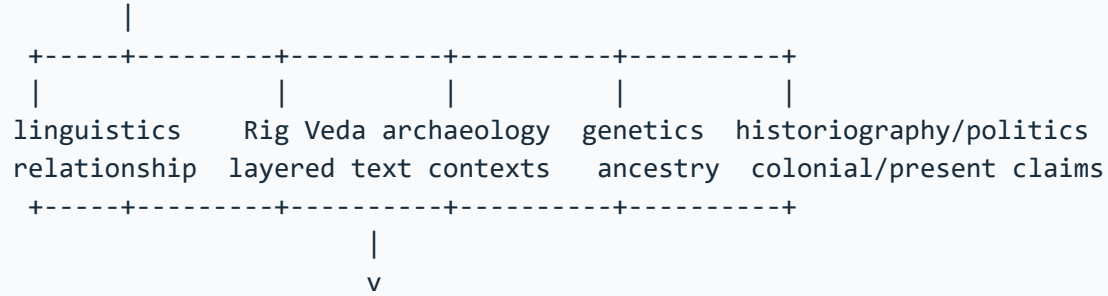
TERM	VALID USE	INVALID COLLAPSE
arya	self/cultural designation	biological race
Indo-Aryan	branch of Indo-Iranian languages	skull type or pure people
Indo-Iranian	linguistic-cultural relationship	one archaeological culture
Aryan culture	reconstructed practices/texts	uniform invading nation

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Separate language, ancestry, material culture and identity before comparison.

QUESTION: how did Indo-Aryan speech and early Vedic culture form in South Asia?

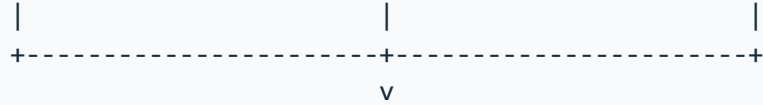


No class alone identifies a group, route, date and cultural outcome.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/9: Working chronology and interaction corridor

SINIASHTA/STEPPE -> CENTRAL ASIAN/RMAC CONTACT -> NORTH-WEST SOUTH ASIA -> VEDIC MILIEU

2nd millennium BCE technology/speech hypotheses -> interaction -> cultural synthesis

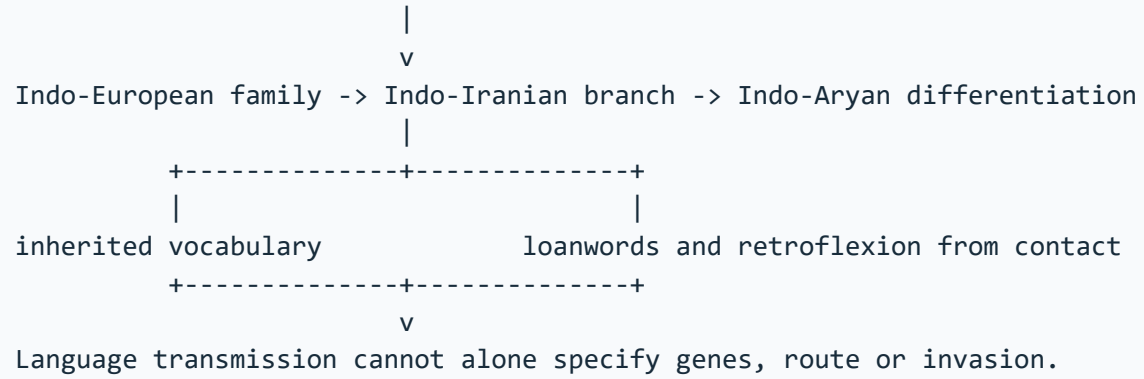


Mitanni Indo-Aryan names and terms provide external attestation in western Asia.

A corridor model is not a mapped army route; scale and social process stay open.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/9: Linguistic evidence: descent plus contact

regular sound correspondences + shared vocabulary + grammar

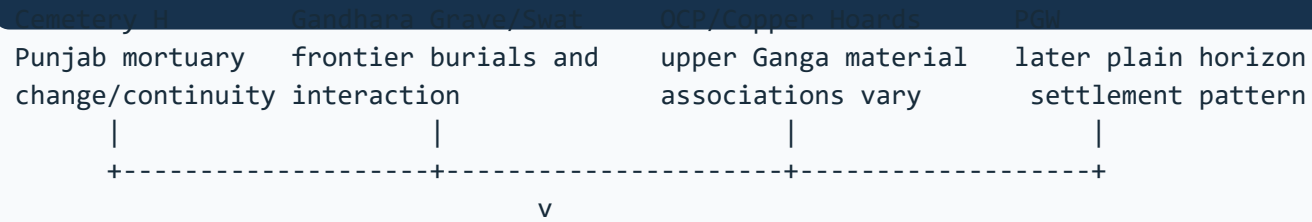


ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/9: Rigvedic identity: a cultural system

RIG VEDA: layered oral corpus in a north-western Sapta-Sindhu milieu

- |-- economy: cattle-centred pastoralism with agriculture and crafts
- |-- polity: jana, vis, rajan, sabha, samiti; no territorial empire
- |-- society: kinship/difference; later caste must not be projected backward
- |-- religion: deities, rita, yajna, soma and praise-poetry
- |-- warfare: horse/chariot terms and cattle/route conflicts
- +> identity is cultural-historical, not a racial phenotype.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/9: Archaeological cultures are not peoples



None equals Aryan people by itself; relate dates, regions and practices cautiously.
Sanauli vehicles cannot settle horse-chariot identity without technical context.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/9: Archaeogenetics: result and claim boundary

ANCIENT SAMPLE → contamination control → genetic components → statistical model

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Rakhigarhi: one Harappan-context genome; not the whole civilisation.

South/Central Asian aDNA models: later Steppe-related ancestry entered South Asia.

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Ancestry can show mixture/timing ranges, not language or self-identity alone.

Sampling is sparse, uneven and vulnerable to political overclaim.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/9: Competing models and best-fit verdict

INVASION: rapid violent replacement -> simplistic and archaeologically weak

IN-MIGRATION: movement over time + interaction -> better multi-source fit

INDIGENOUS/OIT: local formation/outward movement -> must explain linguistic geography,
Mitanni evidence and ancient-DNA patterns

SYNTHESIS: mobility + continuity + borrowing + intermarriage + cultural recomposition

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VERDICT: migration is not conquest; continuity is not isolation; evidence is graded.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/9: Aryan-problem answer architecture

10 MARKS: define categories -> two evidence classes -> one limit -> cautious verdict

15 MARKS: historiography -> linguistic case -> text/archaeology -> genetics -> synthesis

20 MARKS: firewall -> evidence matrix -> corridor -> competing models

-> Harappan continuity/contact -> political misuse -> graded conclusion

EVIDENCE VERB: supports / is consistent with / complicates; avoid proves when indirect.

CLOSE: early Vedic culture formed through mobility and South Asian interaction, not race.